



Alfresco content management solution

at LifeSpring Hospitals too, time is money. “The smooth availability of data across departments (due to HIMS and VoIP) has resulted in the management getting to know about bottlenecks minutes before the occurrence. This allows them to take preventive action,” says Kumar

Cutting hardware requirements and licence costs

LifeSpring's use of Red Hat enterprise virtualisation software has helped reduce hardware requirements and the associated costs. “Using virtualisation, we were able to achieve server consolidation, which resulted in all the applications running on only four [physical] servers. This lowered the hardware costs, and we achieved standardisation of our IT infrastructure,” says Kumar.

LifeSpring uses 110 thin clients and 40 desktops. From the top management to the executives, most run OpenOffice on their systems, resulting in savings in licence costs. “OpenOffice on Ubuntu has itself helped reduce our licensing costs by 80 per cent,” says Kumar.

Lower people costs

Support by Red Hat has resulted in simplified management and maintenance of the entire IT infrastructure, lowering the organisation's manpower requirements. “Today, our IT team consists of only three people, and until now we have comfortably managed to run the entire show without any major hiccups. Any other solution would have required a huge internal IT team to manage it,” says Kumar. Furthermore, the use of an open source LMS has reduced manpower training costs significantly. “Since our organisation is process-based, training is extremely crucial. With our workforce spread across geographies, we were facing huge challenges in coordinating training sessions, resulting in wastage of man days. With little or no investment in Moodle, our employees could take up their training online without wasting any time. Moodle has streamlined our training process, which has resulted in a 60-70 per cent saving on training costs,” says Kumar.



Moodle learning management solution

Improved customer satisfaction

The implementation of open source solutions has improved the productivity of the organisation's business processes, as well as customer satisfaction. “The Open Source Trouble Ticketing System to track complaints both internally, and from external customers, was integrated with our two call centres. This helped resolve operational issues in a very short period of time. Further, the open source VoIP system helped us reach out to customers easily and in a timely manner. Customer satisfaction levels have increased significantly,” says Kumar.

Minor roadblocks

However, the adoption of open source technology has not been hassle-free. Like any organisation, LifeSpring faced transition hurdles such as employee resistance. “Initially, our employees were a bit reluctant to adopt open source, but a well-drawn-up internal training plan and an enabling environment conducive for behavioural change helped us overcome this initial hitch. Today, about all of our users are well-versed in our systems,” says Kumar.

The future: Getting deeper into open source!

Looking ahead, LifeSpring hopes to start getting a return on investment (RoI) beginning from the third year post implementation. The company also plans to implement a disaster recovery (DR) solution. “Today, we have one single location for all the data that people access in real-time. After scaling up, we have a plan to implement DR, again with open source technology,” says Kumar. From LifeSpring's perspective, the adoption of open source will only get stronger with time! 

By: Vanisha Joseph

The author loves to experiment, and writing for LINUX For You is her latest experiment—so beware! Just a minute, she also happens to be a journalist during the day.